

A.14

Policy/Guideline Title:	Professional Registration Policy		
Executive Summary:	This policy outlines the requirements of maintaining professional registration and the process for monitoring registrations.		
Supersedes:	Version 8		
Description of Amendment(s):	Updated policy titles i.e., Grievance and Dignity at Work now Grievance (including Bullying and Harassment) policy		
This policy will impact on:			
Financial Implications:			
Policy Area:	People Division	Approval Date:	April 2023
Version Number:	9	Review Date:	January 2026
Issued By:	Kathryn Large, Senior HR Business Partner	Expiry Date:	April 2026
Author:	Karen Birch, Lead Nurse, Practice Development Nic Nicolaou, Medical Staffing Manager	Impact Assessment Date:	
APPROVAL RECORD			
	Committees / Group	Date	
Consultation:	JCNC Operational Group	28 th March 2023	
Approved by Director:	Catherine Wills, Director of People	28 th March 2023	
Ratified by:	Operational Management Group	20 th April 2023	
Received for Information:			

A.14: Professional Registration Policy



Compassion



Accountability



Respect



Integrity



Courage

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1. Introduction

It is mandatory that employees employed in posts requiring professional registration i.e., Doctors, Nurses, Health Care Professionals, HR and Finance professionals within the Trust are appropriately registered and that this registration is kept up to date at all times.

It is implicit that, in operating this policy, all staff are given the required level of support and training to be aware of their individual responsibilities and achieve the stated aims of this policy.

The policy aims to comply with the spirit as well as the letter of current employment legislation.

2. Purpose

This policy applies to all workers - whether under a contract of employment issued by the Trust, working on the staff bank or employed by an external Staff Agency - who require professional registration in order to carry out their role.

This policy should be read with other relevant policies and procedures including but not exclusively:

- Disciplinary policy
- Capability policy
- Grievance (including Bullying and Harassment) policy
- Standards of Business Conduct
- Recruitment and Selection policy
- Maintaining high professional standards in the modern NHS: conduct, capability and ill-health, policies and procedures for medical & dental practitioners
- Revalidation appraisal policy

3. Responsibilities

Responsibilities of Human Resources

- To provide training and professional advice on the application of this policy.
- Assist managers in managing the process for professional registration of employees.
- Provide professional advice and guidance to managers and staff.
- Treat all matters related to professional registration with impartiality and confidentiality.
- To follow the procedure in relation to Professional Registration as detailed below.

Responsibilities of Line Managers

- To apply this policy in a fair and consistent manner and to follow the procedure in relation to Professional Registration as detailed below.
- To ensure their own familiarity with the policy and procedures

- To ensure that all members of their team are aware of the requirements of the policy and their own individual responsibilities.
- To ensure that professional registration issues are dealt with in a fair and consistent manner and are appropriately documented and recorded.
- To treat any concerns raised within the scope of this policy seriously, confidentially and sensitively.
- To seek advice from the People Partnering team on matters related to professional registration of employees.
- To undertake training and maintain own competency necessary for effectively carrying out this policy.

Responsibilities of All Employees

- To ensure own familiarity with the policy and procedure
- To take responsibility to ensure that their professional registration is up to date at all times and does not lapse or expire.
- To inform their line manager immediately with any concerns or if their registration lapses or expires.
- To adhere to the requirements and purpose of this policy and procedure.
- To co-operate with the management of the Trust in looking into any matters of concern regarding their professional registration.

4. Definitions

Professional Registration

Professional Registration demonstrates that you have reached an internationally recognised standard of competence and acknowledges your commitment to maintaining that competence in the future.

5. All Staff Requiring Registration

It is the duty of the practitioner to ensure that they are appropriately registered before obtaining employment within the Trust (See Appendix 1).

It is the duty of Recruitment Services and Staff Bank to verify that anyone to whom they offer employment in a professional capacity is appropriately registered. This verification must take place prior to the practitioner starting work. Production of a PIN card is not sufficient and a system for checking through the appropriate body should be in place.

The Medical Staffing Department is responsible for ensuring that medical and dental staff are correctly registered with the General Medical Council (GMC) or General Dental Council (GDC) before commencing employment.

Each appropriate line manager is responsible for the establishment of a system for checking through the appropriate body and ensuring this is operating effectively.

The Trust requires a central system to be maintained for recording registration details. When staff commence employment, the necessary information will be entered on to the Electronic Staff Record (ESR), the Trust's computerised information system. Recruitment Services will enter details for non-Medical and Dental registrants and Medical Staffing will enter details for Medical and Dental registrants.

It is the responsibility of each employee to maintain their contact details (address, telephone numbers) with their registering body and to ensure that the name held for them is exactly the same as that held by the Trust (which in turn should be the same as their birth certificate or passport). Where paying by direct debit, the practitioner must ensure their bank account details are correctly recorded by their registering body; particularly where a bank account is changed.

6. Newly Qualified Nurses and Midwives (only)

The Trust will not employ any individuals to a nursing or midwifery post requiring registration until registration is confirmed with the NMC.

Confirmation of qualification, completion of a recognised course and application for registration must be established at interview.

An offer of employment on a nursing or midwifery post is subject to PIN and certificate of registration being seen by the recruiting manager or a nominated individual in the clinical area.

The NMC Confirmation Service must be used prior to confirmation of offers of employment (see Appendix 2).

Newly qualified nurses/healthcare professionals are expected to complete their appropriate preceptorship period as defined by the Agenda for Change terms and conditions.

Pending registration - newly qualified nurses/healthcare professionals and Return to Practice trainees can commence work as a Pre-Registration Nurse/Healthcare Professional paid at Band 4 (Following the relevant Pre-Registration Job description) on completion of their training programme. This is a short-term agreement until receipt of their NMC pin number. On receipt they are expected to inform recruitment services at their earliest convenience to be uplifted to Band 5.

Once registration has been confirmed they shall be paid at the appropriate grade with effect from the date of registration. If registration is not confirmed within a reasonable period of time the Band 2/3 (for Newly Qualified Nurses) or Band 4 (for Newly Qualified Midwives) contract will be terminated.

Where a newly qualified midwife is registered on the General part of the Register then, providing Registration is verified, a temporary appointment as a Registered Nurse can be offered.

7. Staff in Employment

7.1 Maintaining Registration (non-Medical Staff)

It is the responsibility of the individual employee to ensure that their professional registration is maintained at all times. Continuing to report for duty with lapsed registration or out of date Revalidation is a disciplinary offence. If an employee is aware their registration has lapsed or expired or they have not submitted any other information to their registering body, at any time they should speak to their line manager immediately.

It is the responsibility of the line manager as the employer to ensure that all non-medical practitioners within their sphere of control are adequately registered.

Each line manager should ensure that they have their own system in place whereby the registration status of their staff is checked on a regular basis.

In addition, regular reports will be produced from the ESR system by the Workforce Information team detailing registrations that are due to lapse in the next 3 months.

The Workforce Information team will advise the employees by email/letter (see appendix 3), at least 2 months in advance (and copied to the line manager) that their professional registration is due for renewal which will inform the individual of their obligation to ensure that the registration is renewed in time.

It is then the individual employee's responsibility to provide evidence to their line manager at least two weeks prior to the expiry of the registration. HCPC groups of staff evidence of renewal will be posted on the HCPC website and employees should produce evidence of certification of renewal within two weeks of the expiry date.

The line manager will then:

- Check the evidence/documentation provided by the individual.
- Take a copy of the relevant registration documentation, keep it on the employee's personal file.
- In the event of a query the line manager for nursing staff will also verify the registration on the relevant professional body's online/telephone service and print confirmation/record the date and time of call in the employee's personal file.
- For nursing staff – directions for checking NMC registration are provided at Appendix 2.

The Workforce Information team will re-run the reports to ensure that registrants are renewing their registration and update ESR when renewal is confirmed on the relevant web site. Where it has reached 2 weeks before expiry and a renewal has not been completed the details of the registrant(s) will be escalated to the relevant

HR Advisor/Manager. They will in turn liaise with the line manager and registrant to ensure that they take whatever action is necessary to renew their registration in time. The NMC/ESR interface means that registration renewal dates should automatically update on ESR but checking with the professional body will ensure the most up to date information.

If staff have changed their surname since registration, managers should ensure that Birth and Marriage Certificates are seen.

7.2 Nurses and Midwives – Notification of Practice

As required by the NMC, all practitioners are required to register and pay the renewal fee on an annual basis (annual retention) and submit a confirmation of Revalidation every 3 years when they renew their registration. Notification to pay the annual fee will be issued by the NMC 45 days before the expiry date.

Those not completing these forms will be suspended without pay and the process outlined at 7.3 below will be followed.

7.3 Lapsed Registration (Non-Medical Staff)

When a lapsed registration is discovered (including a failure to submit a 'notification of practice' or 'intention to practice' form, the employee will be informed by the line manager that it is not possible to employ them in their current role until notification of renewal is received. This will mean that the employee will be suspended from duty until the notification of the renewal is received and will receive no pay during that period.

In cases of no pay, the line manager will be responsible for notifying Payroll at once.

The line manager will then invite the employee to a formal meeting to ascertain the reasons for the non-renewal (in line with the Trust Disciplinary policy UHN HR01). The employee may be represented at this meeting by a union representative or work colleague not acting in a legal capacity.

The employee will be notified in writing in advance of the above meeting that a possible outcome of the meeting could be a disciplinary sanction in line with the Trust Disciplinary policy UHN HR01.

The line manager will write to the employee within 5 working days of the above meeting to confirm the outcome of the meeting.

Failure to renew and/or provide timely evidence of professional registration on two consecutive occasions will result in further disciplinary action which may result in a disciplinary sanction up to and including dismissal.

Once proof of re-registration is obtained the member of staff shall be reinstated provided that re-registration takes place within two days of the date of expiry. Managers may use their discretion to extend this timeframe in exceptional circumstances only.

Please see the flowchart at Appendix 4 outlining the above process.

7.4 Maintaining Registration (Medical and Dental Staff)

The GMC/ESR interface means that registration renewal dates should automatically be updated on ESR.

The Medical Staffing Department will run a report on ESR to flag GMC Registrations due to lapse within the next 1 month.

The generic email reminder is then sent to the doctor and the monitoring spreadsheet is updated by logging the date the email reminder was sent.

The Medical Staffing Department will then check (on-line) the registration status within one week of expiry (see Appendix 5):

- i. to confirm the doctor's annual retention fee has been paid.
- ii. to clarify the doctor's registration status.

If the registration has been renewed, the information will be updated on ESR, and the monitoring spreadsheet and no further action will be taken – process completed.

If the registration has not been renewed, evidence from the GMC website is printed.

If registration has lapsed the Medical Staffing Manager will contact the relevant Clinical Director and the procedure from section 7.3 will be followed.

8. Registration Checks with External Agencies

All staff that are used within the trust, who come from external agencies are checked to ensure that their registration is current. This is also a requirement within all written agreements with agencies. See appendix 6 for the checklist/process used.

9. Training

Mandatory training for new starters and existing staff is in place. The training covers the content of this policy.

10. Monitoring Compliance with the Document

Monitoring Compliance					
Process to be used for monitoring e.g. audit	Responsible individual / committee for carrying out monitoring	Frequency of monitoring	Responsible individual / committee for review the results	Responsible individual / committee for developing action plan	Responsible individual / committee for monitoring action plan
Audit of registration process	Head of People Planning	Annual	JCNC	Head of People Planning	People Committee

Review of lapsed registrations	Head of People Planning	Annual	JCNC	Head of People Planning	People Committee
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11. References

NMC – The Code – Professional Standards of practice and behaviour for nurses and midwives

Revalidation.nmc.org.uk

RCN guide to Revalidation for Employers; Mitigating the Risks to Your Business

HPC-uk.co.uk/aboutregistration/employers/

www.gmc-uk.org/doctors/revalidation.asp

Appendix 1 - HEALTHCARE PROFESSIONALS COVERED BY REGULATORY BODY

Nursing, Midwifery & Health Visitors

All registered nursing and midwifery staff are required to be registered with the Nursing and Midwifery Council (NMC) and this is renewable every 3 years with an annual fee payable every year (annual retention). A confirmation of Revalidation form also has to be returned every 3 years at the same time as the annual fee for that year. Website: www.nmc-uk.org

Health & Care Professions Council (HCPC)

The following professions are registered with the Health & Care Professions Council and their registration is renewable every two years. Website: www.hcpc-uk.org

Each registrant receives a Certificate of Registration. The issue of these certificates are staged as follows:-

- Radiographers - 1 March
- Physiotherapists - 1 May
- Arts Therapists (Art, Music and Drama Therapists) - 1 June
- Dieticians - 1 July
- Chiropodists and Podiatrists - 1 August
- Orthoptists - 1 September
- Speech & Language Therapists - 1 October
- Prosthetists/Orthotists - 1 October
- Clinical Scientists - 1 October
- Occupational Therapists - 1 November
- Operating Dept Practitioners - 1 December
- Biomedical Scientists - 1 December
- Practitioner Psychologists - 1 June

General Medical Council (GMC)

All Medical staff are required to be registered with the General Medical Council (GMC) or the General Dental Council (GDC) and this is renewable annually. Websites: www.gmc-uk.org and www.gdc-uk.org

General Pharmaceutical Council (GPhC)

Regulates pharmacists and pharmacy technicians who are required to renew their registration every year. Website: www.pharmacyregulation.org

Social Workers

All qualified Social Workers and Social Work Students are required to have professional registration with the General Social Care Council (GSCC) www.gsccl.org.uk. Students on completion of their degree must re-register as a Qualified Social Worker and Qualified Social Workers must renew their registration every 3 years.

Appendix 2 – Checking NMC Registration

The NMC offers a free service, which enables employers to check the status of nurses and midwives.

The only way to check the practitioner has valid registration is to use the NMC registration confirmation service.

There are a variety of ways of using the registration confirmation service, including:

Online: www.nmc-uk.org through the employer's confirmation service. This provides 24 hour access and allows an official confirmation report to be printed.

Telephone (open 8.00 am to 5.00 pm Monday to Friday) 0207 333 9333.

Email: UKenquiries@nmc.uk.org

Overseas enquiries: overseasenquiries@nmc-uk.org

Fitness to practise enquiries: fitness.to.practise@nmc-uk.org

Appendix 3 – Professional Registration Reminder Letter

NAME:
WARD/DEPT:
KGH:
Payroll Number:

Dear

PROFESSIONAL REGISTRATION – RENEWAL (REGISTRATION NUMBER)

Please, ensure the information above is as per your payslip, and matches the information on your Professional Registration exactly. If any changes need to be made, inform your manager, who will complete the necessary paper work, and forward to Workforce Information.

Please be advised that your Professional Registration expires on: (DATE)

You will be aware that it is a mandatory practice that all professional practitioners within the Trust are appropriately registered and that this registration is kept up to date. In order to ensure that we have accurate details surrounding your professional registration, following the renewal of your PIN, please complete the slip below and return to your line manager. Your line manager will check this evidence with your professional body and if satisfactory, they will keep a copy on your personal file. You are advised to refer to HR policy A14 for further detail.

The Trust cannot employ practitioners who are not registered and is obliged to inform the relevant professional body of any unregistered practitioners. You are reminded that it is your own responsibility to ensure that your registration is maintained at all times, even whilst on Maternity leave/Long term sickness. You should provide evidence of your renewal to your line manager at least 2 weeks prior to the expiry of your annual registration. Failure to do so will result in you being suspended from duties. You will be invited to a formal meeting in accordance with the Trust Disciplinary policy, which may result in disciplinary action being taken against you. Failure to maintain your registration on two successive occasions will lead to further disciplinary action being taken against you which may include sanctions up to and including your dismissal.

If you have any queries regarding the contents of this letter, please do not hesitate to contact a member of the People Partnering Team on 01536 491770.

Yours sincerely,

Workforce Information Manager

Please complete and return to your line Manager, following the renewal of your Professional Registration Number.

NAME:.....

WARD/DEPT:.....

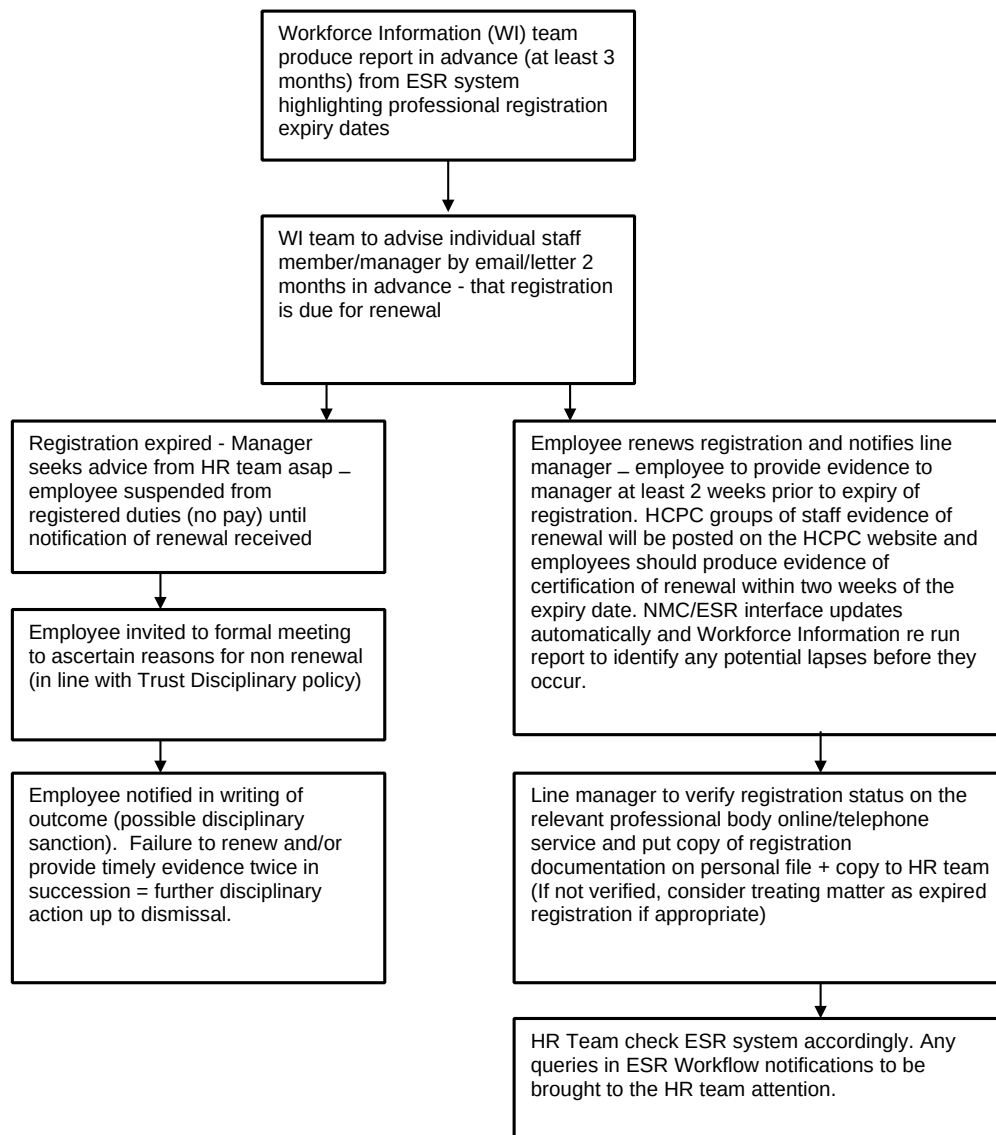
REGISTRATION NUMBER:.....

NEW EXPIRY DATE:.....

SIGNATURE:.....

COPY TO MANAGER TO BE PLACED ON FILE

Appendix 4 - PROCESS CHART – PROFESSIONAL REGISTRATION (NON-MEDICAL)



Appendix 5 - CHECKING GMC/GDC REGISTRATION

The GMC/GDC have on-line registers which provide up to date information on the registration status of doctors and dentists.

The GMC website is at <http://www.gmc-uk.org>

The GDC website is at <http://www.gdc-uk.org>

The GMC telephone number is 0161 923 6602.

Email: registrationhelp@gmc-uk.org

The Medical Staffing Department will print a copy of the registration status (which will show the type of registration held, expiry date and any warnings) and file in the doctor's personnel file.

The Medical Staffing Department will confirm the doctor holds the correct registration:

- a. All doctors must hold Full Registration with a Licence to Practice.
- b. Consultants must also be on the Specialist Register.

This information is then entered onto ESR. There is an on-line interface between ESR and the GMC register which automatically updates registration renewal dates and other information. Errors or warnings are sent to the Trust via ESR through Workflow Notifications.

Doctors who do not hold correct GMC Registration must not start work and will not be paid.

Appendix 6 - Agency worker placement checklist

Authority name (location)		Authority reference no. (if provided)	000000000000		
Reason for Booking (if provided)					
Job Profile Title		Band	6	EPP?	Yes / No / N/A
Placement date from	DD/MM/YYYY	Placement date to	DD/MM/YYYY		
Proposed working pattern	Shift times			Total number of hours booked	000

Hourly Pay Rate incl. any adjustments, as appropriate	£00.00	Total hourly charge excl. VAT	£00.00
Hourly Agency fee	£00.00	VAT (as appropriate)	£00.00

Agency Worker's full name	John Doe Smith				
Previously worked at the Authority as above?	Yes / No	Available for full placement period?	Yes / No* (*see below)	Recent photograph attached	Yes / No
Verified ID	United Kingdom Passport			Attached	Yes / No
Nationality and Immigration status (Right to Work in UK)	Not applicable (as above)			Attached	Yes / No

Relevant Professional and Regularly Body registration (as appropriate)	GCD / HPC / NMC
Relevant Professional and Regularly Body registration number (as appropriate)	0000000
Relevant Professional and Regularly Body registration last checked (as appropriate)	DD/MM/YYYY
Agency Worker's Date of Birth	DD/MM/YYYY

Enhanced DBS disclosure no.	000000000000	Date DBS issued	DD/MM/YYYY
		Date DBS expires	DD/MM/YYYY
Enhanced DBS disclosure name of employer	Name of employer that obtained enhanced DBS disclosure	Regulated Activities status checked date	DD/MM/YYYY

Certificate of Fitness for Employment issued by	Name of OH Service Provider	Date issued	DD/MM/YYYY
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Competent in oral and written English	Yes / No	Two references attached	Yes / No	Alert notification?	Subject / Not subject
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Other information as required by the Authority	
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The above named Agency Worker has been submitted by the Supplier for consideration in the provision of the Services i) in response to a request from the Authorised Officer of the Authority; ii) has undergone all of the necessary and appropriate pre-employment screening checks as required by the NHS Conditions of Contract for the supply of agency workers to ensure their compliance prior to supply and iii) shall be charged in accordance with the Contract Price set out in Appendix 2 to the Framework Agreement (or Escalated Contract Price as agreed with the Senior Authorised Officer of the Authority).

Name		Position	
Signature		Date	DD/MM/YYYY